AI now helps write the software that runs machines. C and C++, the languages most of it is written in, can't check what that software will never do.

Batteries, flywheels and flight controls run on code that people test and review, and then trust.

In Mentl, a language I built, the rule is part of the code: the compiler checks it through every function the code calls, and a version that breaks it does not build.

The rule is part of the code, and the compiler checks it through every call.

You write the rule into the code: this never touches the internet, this never writes a file, this never allocates memory.

The compiler checks the rule through every function the code calls. **Break it, and the program won't build.**

Seven months and 2,600 commits since March. The compiler is written in Mentl and compiles itself. Open source: github.com/ampactor-labs/mentl

✕ Refused

One line broke the rule.

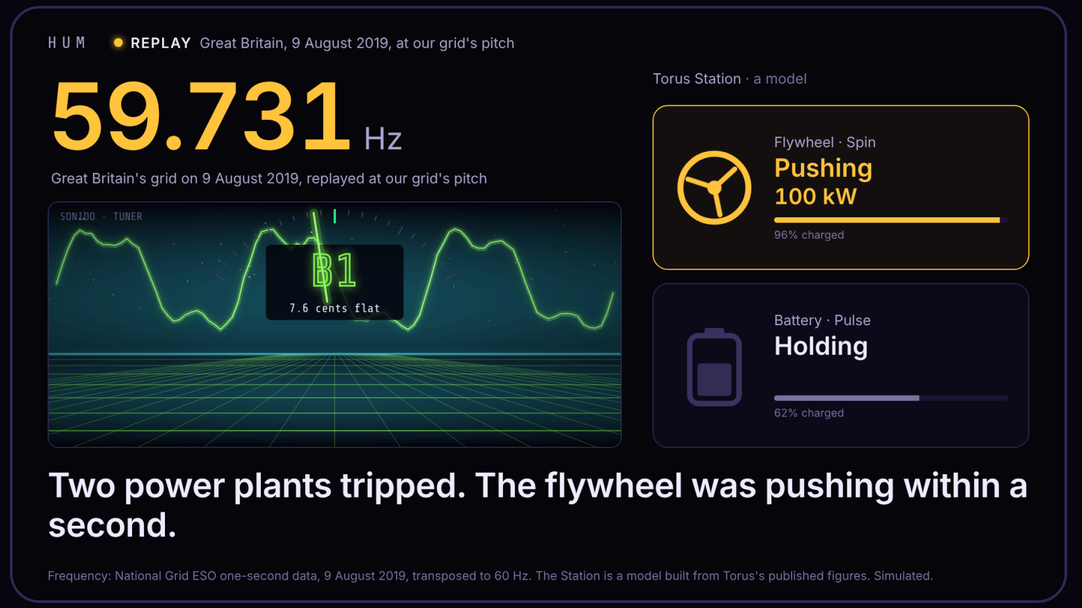
```
let price = price_m("https://api.eia.gov/…")
```

This decision is marked as never reaching the internet. Add one line that reads a price online, and the compiler won't build it. Its error names the path the price lookup took.

Show it working

Built this week: software that measures the power grid from a wall's wiring.

- **A guitar pickup picks up the grid's hum** in any room, and my audio library, sonido, measures its frequency to a thousandth of a hertz.
- **A model of a Torus Station decides** what to do, typically in under a millisecond, with software written in Mentl.
- **Its rules are in the code**, and the compiler checks them through every function it calls: it never reaches the internet, never allocates memory and never stops with an error.



Before Monday 4 PM: the language, 2,610 commits since March 15, and sonido, 461 commits since January 25. Since then: everything on this slide.

Who needs it in Utah

TORUS · SALT LAKE CITY

Builds flywheel-and-battery Stations that steady the grid. The software inside each Station is where a proof would matter first. Torus is judging this demo.

HILL AFB · 309TH SOFTWARE ENGINEERING GROUP

Maintains flight software for the F-16, the F-35 and the missile fleet, where every claim about the software needs evidence.

The sites I'll ask to host the pilot: Torus, Rocky Mountain Power's Wattsmart Battery program, and Utah State University's ASPIRE center.
First hires: a controls engineer and a compiler engineer, in Salt Lake City.

What $10,000 unlocks

$10,000 puts this controller beside a real battery in Utah within ninety days.

Day 30 Form the Utah company. Run the controller on a 3 kW inverter and 10 kWh of batteries on my bench.

Day 60 With a site's written consent, run it read-only beside a real battery for 14 days, logging its decisions and sending no commands.

Day 90 A pilot agreement that lets it send commands, and an SBIR proposal with Nucleus Grow.

$7,000 for the bench. **$3,000** for the company, a lawyer for the pilot agreement, a year of insurance and the site's read-only kit. Every line is priced in the budget.

Three asks. A Utah operator who will host it. An introduction to Hill AFB's 309th. A co-founder who knows power electronics.

BACKUP

What is proven, exactly

THE CONTROLLER'S RULE	STATUS
No network, file, clock or other call outside the program while it decides	Proven by the compiler through every call
No memory allocated while it decides	Proven
The flywheel within 100 kW, the battery within 300 kW	Proven: each machine answers a command with a power inside its rating, and the compiler checks the answer
It never stops with an error	Proven for every function the controller defines; one byte-range check inside the library's print routine is not proven yet
Its decisions are good	Tested on recordings, not proven

The compiler is written in Mentl, and the pinned binary rebuilds itself byte for byte. The first four rows are checked through every call, and a copy that breaks one does not build.

Checked by the compiler: mentl audit examples/grid/station.mn, and mentl why for each rule

BACKUP

From the laptop to the pedal: the engineering left

WHAT STANDS IN THE WAY	MEASURED TODAY	THE FIX
No WebAssembly engine on the pedal's chip	The controller is a 43 KB WebAssembly file	Embed an interpreter written in Rust, or compile the file to C
Declared for threads	The memory is declared shared; there is no atomic instruction and no thread import	Drop the word for a program that starts no thread, a one-line change in the compiler
Memory	Fixed: the same peak after 300,000 readings as after one	Done; each reading runs in an arena that is reclaimed when it ends
Speed	About 291,000 instructions per reading	Pass numbers instead of text

The decision allocates nothing and the loop reclaims each reading's memory. The work left is the engine on the chip.